

Lesson 12: Future Simple - I'm going to, will, and shall

Introduction to Future Simple Tenses

"Welcome, everyone. In this session, we will explore the future simple tenses, specifically 'I'm going to,' 'will,' and 'shall.' These tenses are crucial for discussing future plans and intentions in the IT world.

'I'm going to' is used for plans or intentions. For instance, 'I'm going to update the software tomorrow.' It shows a decision made before speaking.

'Will' is used for decisions made at the moment of speaking or for predictions. Like, 'I will check the server issue,' or 'The new model will probably be faster.'

'Shall,' though less common and more formal, can be used instead of 'will,' especially for offers or suggestions, like 'Shall we begin the meeting?'

In IT, we frequently plan future actions or predict outcomes. How do you usually talk about future plans or predictions in your work?"

Different Ways to Use Future Simple

"Using 'I'm going to' for Planned Actions:

1. **For Pre-decided Plans:** 'I'm going to attend the cybersecurity webinar next week.' It refers to plans you have already made.

2. **For Predictions Based on Present Evidence:** 'Look at those dark clouds. It's going to rain.' It's about predictions when there is some present evidence or indication.

Using 'Will' for On-the-spot Decisions:

1. ****For Spontaneous Decisions****: 'I will send you the report by EOD.' It's used when you decide something at the moment of speaking.
2. ****For Predictions Without Present Evidence****: 'I think the next software update will fix the bug.' It's for predictions based on your opinion, not on any present evidence.

'Using 'Shall' for Offers and Suggestions:

1. ****For Offers****: 'Shall I help you with that coding problem?' It's a polite offer.
2. ****For Suggestions****: 'Shall we discuss this in tomorrow's meeting?' It's a polite suggestion or proposal.

In the IT sector, how do you decide which of these to use when talking about future events or actions?"

Dialogue between IT Professionals

"Let's look at a dialogue between two IT professionals, Zoe and Max, using these tenses:

Zoe: Max, are you ready for the software launch next month?

Max: Yes, I'm going to finalize the testing phase by next week.

Zoe: Great. Do you think we will meet the deadline?

Max: I believe we will. There are no major issues left to address.

Zoe: Shall we schedule a meeting with the marketing team to discuss the launch strategy?

Max: Good idea. Shall I set it up for Monday?

***Zoe**: Please do. Also, I'm going to prepare a presentation on the key features.*

***Max**: Alright. I think the clients will be impressed with the new updates.*

***Zoe**: I hope so. We've been working hard on this.*

This conversation demonstrates the use of 'I'm going to' for planned actions, 'will' for predictions and spontaneous decisions, and 'shall' for making suggestions and offers."

Future Simple in IT Planning

"When planning IT projects or activities, how do you talk about future steps or stages? Using 'I'm going to' for planned actions or 'will' for predictions and immediate decisions can provide clarity about future plans. For instance, 'I'm going to work on the project plan next week,' or 'I think the client will approve the proposal.'

Think about your upcoming IT projects or tasks. How do you communicate your future plans? Do you use 'I'm going to' or 'will' to outline your planned activities or predictions?"

Future Simple in IT Team Meetings

"In team meetings, especially in IT, how do we discuss future team activities or responsibilities? We often use 'I'm going to' for actions we have planned as a team. For example, 'We are going to upgrade the system next month.' It's a team plan for the future.

Consider your last team meeting. How did you and your team members talk about future tasks or events? Did you use 'I'm going to' or 'will' to discuss your plans and schedules?"

Future Simple for Client Discussions

"When discussing future projects or timelines with clients, how do we effectively communicate scheduled activities or plans? Using 'I'm going to' for planned actions and 'will' for predictions and on-the-spot decisions helps to set clear expectations. For example, 'We are going to review your proposal next Tuesday' (planned action) and 'The project will likely be completed by the end of the quarter' (prediction).

How do you handle such discussions with clients? Do you find these future tenses useful for explaining future activities or schedules?"

Dialogue: Future IT Project Discussion

"Imagine a dialogue between two IT colleagues discussing a future project:

***Liam**:* Hey Ava, are you involved in the upcoming server migration?

***Ava**:* Yes, I am. I'm going to handle the data backup process.

***Liam**:* That's essential. Do you think it will take long?

***Ava**:* It might take a couple of days. I will let you know once I have a clearer timeline.

***Liam**:* Shall we coordinate with the network team as well?

***Ava**:* Definitely. We shall need their assistance for a smooth transition.

****Liam**:** *I'm going to prepare a checklist for the migration steps.*

****Ava**:** *Great. I think that will help us stay organized and on track.*

This conversation between Liam and Ava illustrates the use of 'I'm going to' for their personal plans, 'will' for predictions and decisions, and 'shall' for suggestions and offers."

Future Simple for IT Project Predictions

"When we talk about future outcomes in IT projects, which tense do we often use? We typically use 'will' for predictions. For instance, 'I think the new software will improve our efficiency.' This expresses a belief or opinion about the future.

Now, reflect on your own work. When you predict the outcome of a project or a task, how do you phrase it? Do you use 'will' to express your predictions?"

Choosing Between 'I'm going to' and 'Will'

"In IT, when you decide between 'I'm going to' and 'will,' how do you choose? 'I'm going to' is for plans or intentions you've thought about before, like 'I'm going to learn Python this year.' 'Will' is for decisions made at the moment of speaking, like 'I will help you with that problem.'

Think about a situation where you had to make a quick decision at work. Did you use 'will' to express that decision? How do you differentiate between your planned actions and spontaneous decisions?"

Using 'Shall' in Formal IT Settings

"Shall' is less common but still used, especially in formal or polite IT settings. It's often used in offers or suggestions, like 'Shall we test the system again?' or 'Shall I arrange a meeting with the client?'

In your professional interactions, especially in formal meetings or emails, how often do you use 'shall'? Do you find it useful for making polite suggestions or offers?"

Engaging with Your Audience

"Imagine you are planning a major IT upgrade. How would you communicate this to your team? Would you say, 'We are going to start the upgrade next month,' using 'I'm going to' for a pre-planned action? Or in a team meeting, might you say, 'We will review all the steps today,' using 'will' for an on-the-spot decision?"

How do you decide which tense to use when discussing future plans or actions in your team meetings? Do you think the choice of tense affects how your message is received?"

Personal Teaching Experience

"In my online English classes, an IT student once asked, 'When should I use 'I'm going to' instead of 'will' for my project plans?' It was an excellent question. I explained that 'I'm going to' is used for plans thought out beforehand. For instance, 'I'm going to present the project proposal next Wednesday.' It shows a plan already in place. 'Will' is for decisions made while speaking, such as, 'I will send you the project details by tonight.'

Do you recall being unsure about which future tense to use in professional communication? How did you decide?"

Future Simple in IT Client Proposals

"When drafting IT client proposals, how do we express future plans and commitments? We often use 'I'm going to' for actions we plan to undertake, like 'We are going to implement a new security protocol.' We use 'will' for promises or actions decided at the moment of writing, like 'We will ensure the project is completed on schedule.'

Think about your last proposal or email to a client. How did you use these tenses to convey reliability and commitment?"

Future Simple in Professional Development

"In the context of professional development in IT, how do we talk about our future learning goals or career plans? We might use 'I'm going to' for specific plans, like 'I'm going to complete a certification in cloud computing.' For less definite plans or willingness, 'will' is more suitable, like 'I will focus more on developing my AI skills.'

How do you articulate your future professional development plans? Do you find 'I'm going to' or 'will' more appropriate for expressing your goals?"

Dialogue: Discussing Future IT Strategy

"Let's consider a dialogue between two IT managers discussing their department's future strategy:

***Elliot**: Nora, have you thought about our approach to the upcoming AI integration?*

***Nora**: Yes, I have. I'm going to propose a phased integration plan.*

***Elliot**: Sounds good. Do you think the team will adapt quickly?*

***Nora**: I believe they will. Most of them are eager to work on AI projects.*

***Elliot**: Shall we organize some preliminary training sessions for the team?*

***Nora**: That's a great idea. We shall start with a basic introduction to AI.*

***Elliot**: I'm also planning to attend a seminar on AI applications next month.*

***Nora**: That will be beneficial. Keep me updated on what you learn.*

This conversation shows how Elliot and Nora use 'I'm going to' for their definite plans, 'will' for predictions and instant decisions, and 'shall' for formal suggestions."

Continuous Improvement in Communication

"In IT, as well as in language learning, adapting our communication to different contexts is a key part of continuous improvement. Reflecting on your daily professional interactions, how do you decide which future tense to use? Do you find certain situations more suited for 'I'm going to,' others for 'will,' and some for 'shall'?"
